nature; the first line has five syllables; the second, seven; and the third, five

Limerick: a funny verse in five lines; lines one, three and five rhyme, as do two and four

Metaphor: a direct comparison

Narrative: a poem that tells a story

Onomatopoeia: words whose sounds make you think of their meanings

Personification: a comparison in which something that is not human is described with human characteristics

Repetition: the repeating of a word or phrase to add rhythm

Rhythm: the pattern of accented and unaccented syllables in a line of poetry

Simile: a comparison that uses the words 'like' or 'as'

A sample poem:

Give me a Poem

Give me a poem as soft as sleep;
as dangerous as money;
as bitter as a nasty pill;
as sweet as summer honey;
and wrap it in a web of words,
as strong and fine as silk;
as free as flocks of wheeling birds;
as nourishing as milk.
If you give me a poem like that,
I'll tell you what I'll do
If you give me a poem like that,
I'll give one back to you!

- Helen H. Moore

Writing a book review

What is a Book Review?

The review is basically a statement of opinion about a piece of writing (or any other work of art, such as dance, sculpture, or music) which is substantiated with specific facts and incidents from the work itself. Its primary purpose is to let the reader know whether it would be worth their while to read the work under discussion. Though you will have to include some information about the content of the work, never forget that the object of the review is the presentation of the reviewer's opinion.

Thus the primary concern is to make the reader aware of what you think or feel about the work of art. When the work being analysed is literature, the critical essay is called literary criticism. It is this type of essay that encompasses the book review, and, hence, the primary concern of this section.

In the book review, you as the critic can concern yourself with any one or several of the following:

1. Impressions – What are your reactions to the work? Did you like it? Did it appeal to your emotions, to your intellect, or to both?
2. Analysis – How does the author accomplish his/her avowed objective? Is the style effective? Is the genre appropriate for the subject matter? How effective is his/ her diction? The character delineation? The choice of setting? Is the work too long or too short? How extensive is the author's knowledge of the subject matter?
3. Interpretation – What does the work mean? What is the author trying to tell us? Can the work be understood

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